

The Sands of Time Are Sinking

Text: A. R. Cousin, 1857

Music: Edward F. Rimbault, 1867

RUTHERFORD 76.76.76.75

The musical score is written for a single voice part in treble clef, with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#) and a 2/2 time signature. The melody is simple and hymn-like, with notes often beamed together in pairs. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at various points: E, B, C#m, A, E, A, B, B7, E, B7/F#, E, F#m/A, E, B, E, E, A, Am, E, A, Am, E, E, A, E, B7/F#, E, B7, E. The lyrics are arranged in four systems, with four verses of text under each system. The first system has four verses, the second and third have three verses each, and the fourth has four verses. The lyrics describe the sinking of the sands of time and the dawn of heaven, mentioning the King, Christ, the bride, and the Lamb.

E B C#m A E A B

1 The sands of time are sink - ing, the dawn of hea - ven breaks.
2 The King there in his bea - ty with - out a veil is seen;
3 O Christ, he is the foun - tain, the deep sweet well of love!
4 The bride eyes not her gar - ment, but her dear bride-groom's face;

B7 E B7/F# E F#m/A E B E

the sum - mer morn I've sighed for, the fair sweet morn a - wakes;
it were a well-spent jour - ney, though sev'n deaths lay be - tween:
The streams on earth I've tast - ed, more deep I'll drink a - bove:
I will not gaze at glo - ry, but on my King of grace;

E A Am E A Am E

dark, dark hath been the mid - night, but day - spring is at hand,
the Lamb with his fair ar - my doth on Mount Zi - on stand.
there to an o - cean full - ness his mer - cy doth ex - pand,
not at the crown he gift - eth, but on his pier - cèd hand:

E A E B7/F# E B7 E

and glo - ry, glo - ry dwell - eth in Em - man - uel's land.
and glo - ry, glo - ry dwell - eth in Em - man - uel's land.
and glo - ry, glo - ry dwell - eth in Em - man - uel's land.
the Lamb is all the glo - ry of Em - man - uel's land.